Aviation Investigation Final Report

Location:	Myakka City, Florida	**Accident Number:**	ERA25LA089
Date & Time:	December 21, 2024, 18:00 Local	**Registration:**	UNREG
Aircraft:	Buckeye Dream Machine	**Aircraft Damage:**	None
Defining Event:	Collision with terr/obj (non-CFIT)	**Injuries:**	1 Serious
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General aviation - Personal		

Analysis

The non-certificated pilot of the unregistered powered parachute had no formal flight training, but had watched internet videos showing how it was operated. On the day of the accident, he departed from a baseball field and completed an uneventful first solo flight. His second flight was the accident flight. The pilot stated that as he started the takeoff roll for the flight, he realized that he was too close to a fence that surrounded the baseball field but decided to continue the takeoff anyway. As the takeoff continued, the pilot described that there was a gust of wind, and the powered parachute subsequently contacted the fence, seriously injuring the pilot. The powered parachute was not damaged. The pilot did not report that there were any preimpact mechanical malfunctions or failures of the powered parachute that would have precluded normal operation.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be:

The non-certificated pilot’s improper decision to operate the powered parachute in close proximity to a fence, which resulted in a collision with the fence during takeoff. Also causal was the pilot’s decision to operate the powered parachute without having received any formal training.

Findings

Personnel issues	Decision making/judgment - Pilot
Environmental issues	Fence/fence post - Decision related to condition
Personnel issues	Total instruct/training recvd - Pilot

Factual Information

History of Flight

Takeoff	Collision with terr/obj (non-CFIT) (Defining event)

Pilot Information

Certificate:	None	**Age:**	26,Male
Airplane Rating(s):	None	**Seat Occupied:**	Front
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	4-point
Instrument Rating(s):	None	**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):	None	**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:	None None	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	
Occupational Pilot:	No	**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:	0 hours (Total, all aircraft), 0 hours (Total, this make and model)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Buckeye	**Registration:**	UNREG
Model/Series:	Dream Machine	**Aircraft Category:**	Powered parachute
Year of Manufacture:		**Amateur Built:**	
Airworthiness Certificate:	None	**Serial Number:**	unknown
Landing Gear Type:	Tricycle	**Seats:**	2
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	Unknown	**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	800 lbs
Time Since Last Inspection:		**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:		**Engine Manufacturer:**	Rotax
ELT:	Not installed	**Engine Model/Series:**	582
Registered Owner:	On file	**Rated Power:**	50 Horsepower
Operator:	On file	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual (VMC)	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:	VNC,19 ft msl	**Distance from Accident Site:**	23 Nautical Miles
Observation Time:	18:15 Local	**Direction from Accident Site:**	225°
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Clear	**Visibility**	10 miles
Lowest Ceiling:	None	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	9 knots / None	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	None / None
Wind Direction:	310°	**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	N/A / N/A
Altimeter Setting:	30.15 inches Hg	**Temperature/Dew Point:**	0°C / 0°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	Myakka City, FL	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:	Myakka City, FL	**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:		**Type of Airspace:**	Class G

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 Serious	**Aircraft Damage:**	None
Passenger Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:		**Aircraft Explosion:**	None
Total Injuries:	1 Serious	**Latitude, Longitude:**	27.340327,-82.137442

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Boggs, Daniel
Additional Participating Persons:	Wayne Browning; FAA/FSDO; Tampa, FL
Original Publish Date:	July 3, 2025
Last Revision Date:	
Investigation Class:	Class 4
Note:	The NTSB did not travel to the scene of this accident.
Investigation Docket:	https://data.ntsb.gov/Docket?ProjectID=199501

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The NTSB does not assign fault or blame for an accident or incident; rather, as specified by NTSB regulation, "accident/incident investigations are fact-finding proceedings with no formal issues and no adverse parties … and are not conducted for the purpose of determining the rights or liabilities of any person" (Title 49 *Code of Federal Regulations* section 831.4). Assignment of fault or legal liability is not relevant to the NTSB's statutory mission to improve transportation safety by investigating accidents and incidents and issuing safety recommendations. In addition, statutory language prohibits the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report (Title 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b)). A factual report that may be admissible under 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b) is available here.